

a ticket, with the following table:

Priority Level	Compliance	Impact	Occurrence
Project involved			
-----	-----	-----	-----
p1 (~PopsEng::Priority::1)	yes	Any	daily, weekly or monthly n/a
p1 (~PopsEng::Priority::1)	no	OKR progression	n/a
p2 (~PopsEng::Priority::2)	no	Company	daily, weekly
comp calc, nom bot, or conservatory			
p3 (~PopsEng::Priority::3)	no	Division, Department or Team	daily, weekly
nom bot or conservatory			
p4 (~PopsEng::Priority::4)	no	Any	daily, weekly
n/a			
p5 (~PopsEng::Priority::5)	no	Any	monthly, yearly
n/a			

Our issues will be labeled according to the priority level. Anything that falls outside of the table won't be labeled with a priority and will be added to our backlog and worked after priority items are completed. As this is a first iteration, we will review those without labels to see if they should've been labeled differently and if we need to rework this table.

Kanban

Currently we moved away from monthly milestone and are trying out a Kanban approach for our work. The board can be found [here](#). The column Workflow::Next Up is the one that determines our next work.

The People Engineering team, tries to keep that column at about 4 tickets / engineer, so it's clear what our next priorities are. To determine what gets moved into that column, we use our priority labels. However there are two exceptions on the priority labels:

- issues labeled bug: these are tickets that often need to be fixed asap as this is usual an existing project or integration that is broken
- issues labeled code maintenance: these are tickets like library updates or refactors that we need to plan in to make sure our code stays up to standards and secure

Review process

1. Assign your merge request to anyone in the People Group Engineering team
1. They will review it. Once the review is done, they will assign it back to you.
1. If the merge request was not approved yet, address the feedback and assign it back to the reviewer.
1. Continue the previous two steps until the merge request is approved.
1. If you have merge rights, merge the merge request. If you don't have merge rights, ask the

reviewer to merge it.

Current projects

We've build several automations and tools to support our People Group. In the following pages, you can find more details about all the different projects or automations we've created:

Team member's employment

- Onboarding Automations
- Organization Change Automations
- Offboarding Automations

Supportive tools for People Group

- Nominator Bot
- Compensation Calculator
- Inclusive Language Check on Job Families
- People Ops Internal Handbook

Uncategorized

- Smaller syncs
- Slack Integrations

Data

Single Source of truth

For all automations we use 2 main sources:

- Workday: their database acts as the single source of truth for everything related to the team member. We make use of a custom middleware from the People Group Engineering Team's Ruby gem, and interact with Workday using a bot user with limited access to employee details.
- Greenhouse: this is our single source of truth for everything related to candidates (so before they are hired). We make use of a fork from the Greenhouse Ruby gem, and interact with Greenhouse using a user with access to candidates details.

If any other sources are used for a specific integration or automation, it is mentioned on the section.

Confidentiality

When a project uses API tokens with a certain level of access, we mirror the public project to a private project on ops.gitlab.net. These projects are only used to execute the scheduled jobs. For all planning, coding and collaboration we use the public projects.

Access to ChatOps for PeopleOps Team

Before the PeopleOps team member can execute the chat commands mentioned on this page, they need to be invited to the employment-automation project. This can be done by the owners of the project.

Once you are a member of the project, you can run any /pops command. The PeopleOps bot will respond that you first have to connect your GitLab account. You can click the provided URL and authorize. Now you are able to run the /pops commands.

SECTION: people-group/engineering/employment-issues.md

Employment issues

People Connect Team members make use of GitLab's ChatOps functionality to automate creation of Onboarding, Offboarding and Career Mobility issues. By executing a Slack command a pipeline is triggered in the employment-automation project, which runs the related job and replies with a link to the newly created issue.

When these employment issues are created, we also add it to the team member's epic. If there's no existing epic yet, we create one in the Team Member Project. The epic has the team member's name as the title and this is also how we do the lookup for the epic.

The templates used for the creation of the issues and the issues itself are in two different projects. Templates live within the people-group, while the issues live in the Team Member Epics group. The templates are public but the issues remain private. Any updates to the templates can be done in the Employment Templates project.

Onboarding issues

See our Onboarding Automation Flow for more information on current onboarding automations and manual triggers.

Offboarding issues

See our Offboarding Automation flow for more information on current offboarding automations.

Organization Change issues

See our Organization Change Automation Flow for more information on current Career Mobility automations and manual triggers.

Epics

We add all the employment issues for the team member in

one epic. To de-clutter the epics, we set up automation to close these epics.

We have a scheduled pipeline to close those epics that have no open issues linked to them. This pipeline will add a comment on the epic that it is being automatically closed.

Currently, the pipeline is scheduled to be run at 11:00 AM UTC on every Wednesday

Note that when a new issue is added to a closed epic, we will re-open the epic.

Creating an Employment Template

Many of our automation's regarding team members rely on some employment templates. These allow us to dynamically create department and role specific tasks that can then be maintained by the departments themselves.

Quick Links

[Template Task](#)	[Project](#)
[Access Request](#)	[Click Me](#)
[Career Mobility](#)	[Click Me](#)
[Onboarding](#)	[Click Me](#)
[Offboarding](#)	[Click Me](#)

Finding the Right Project

First things first we will have to solve the issue of: What project does or should my template live in?.

We currently have a two different projects responsible for housing templates:

- Team Member Epics - Access Requests
 - Role baseline access request (AKA Role Based Entitlements)
- People Operations - Employment Templates
 - Onboarding - The steps a new team member needs to take in order to perform the tasks of their role.
 - Career Mobility - Any extra tasks needed to be completed when an internal team member is becoming a manager or transferring internally as one.
 - Offboarding - Country, Entity, Division, and Departmental specific required deprovisioning and compliance templates.

Finding the Associated Task

Now that we have successfully navigated to the corresponding project, we can start creating our template. To ensure that we are able to create the associated templates correctly, we follow quite a strict naming convention.

To start viewing the different potential tasks, let's navigate to the .gitlab/issuetemplates folder of the associated project.

All of the issuetemplates folder's children, ie: onboardingtasks, offboardingtasks, etc are mapped to a specific task.

All Task Folder Names

- Onboarding - onboardingtasks
- Access Requests - rolebaselineaccessrequesttasks
- Career Mobility - careermobilitytasks
- Offboarding - offboardingtasks

In our task directory we can also create generalized tasks for a specific entity, country, or department.

These will be added to the specific task based on the team members current entity, country, department, and role. More on how these work in this section.

Finding the Folder Name for your Department

Now that we have successfully navigated to the correct corresponding task folder, now comes the tricky part, finding the folder name for your department.

For all department folders they will follow this convention:

department<departmentname>

- Expects the directory name to start with department.
- Expects departmentname to be lowercase, and spaces replaced with underscores.

For the majority of departments this will be the case, although we must note that these can differ from what your department is actually called. For example, Public Sector would be referred to as departmentpubsec.

If you are unsure of what your department's name in Workday is, please open an issue in the People Group Engineering project and we will get back to you with the name and location of the templates for the desired role.

Finding Role File Names

All of the role files will follow the same naming convention:

role<rolename>.md

- Expects the file name to start with role.
- Expects <rolename> to be lowercase, and spaces replaced with underscores.

The task and department directories, as well as the role files will always follow the same naming convention.

Template Creation Full Example

To help better understand the workflow on how this works, let's walk through creating a full blown template hierarchy.

- > Let's say we have a new team member, John Doe, who is joining GitLab as a People Group Fullstack Engineer.
- > John would be in the People Group division, and the People Operations department.
- > John currently lives in the United States and would fall under the GitLab Inc entity.

Now that we have this information, we can go ahead and create templates for each of the highlighted fields if we would like to. Let's create some new templates for the onboarding tasks regarding this role.

To get started let's navigate to the correct project and associated onboarding tasks folder.

Now that we are in our task folder we can see some directories following the department<departmentname> naming convention. Let's hold off on creating or finding that directory as we first would like to create entity, country, division, and department specific onboarding tasks.

Entity, country, division, and department templates will always be added to the specific tasks folder and not the associated departments folder.

- > I find looking at the org chart in Workday (View All Apps > Directory > My Org Chart) to be useful for clarifying how some of these hierarchical structures roll into one another and can help clarify what the file name may be called.

Creating an Entity Specific Task

Let's start off with creating an entity wide template for anyone in the Inc department by creating a new file in the onboarding tasks folder.

Because our entity is referenced in Workday as Inc, and we must follow the same naming convention, our file would be named: entityinc.md.

Now we can fill in our entity specific onboarding tasks into the template. Once merged this will then be added to all team members onboarding issues in that entity.

Creating a Country Specific Task

Since our new team member John lives in the United States, let's go ahead and create another file. This time we follow the same naming convention and name this: countryunitedstates.md.

We can then go in and fill out the desired information we wish to include here for all onboarding team members that live in the United States. Once merged, any new onboarding issues opened for team members in the United States, will include this template along with the rest of their department/role/entity specific tasks.

Creating a Division Specific Task

Let's also create a division specific task, not only for John, but everyone in the People Group.

Once again following the same naming convention, we would create a file named: `divisionpeoplegroup.md`. Once we add the desired information to this file and merge, we will begin to see this added to all onboarding issues opened for individuals within the People Group.

Creating a Department Specific Task

And finally, before we get to the role specific onboarding task, lets create another task for anyone that may be in the People Operations department.

One more time following the same naming convention as some of the previous steps, let's create a file named: `departmentpeopleoperations.md` in which again we can add our information to and merge to start seeing the changes added to onboarding issues for all team members in the People Operations department.

Creating the Department Directory

Because John's department would be People Operations, we would follow pretty much exactly the same name as our department wide template above. We would name this directory `departmentpeopleoperations`.

We can now add role specific templates to this directory.

Creating the Role Specific Task

To create the role specific task file we will need to ensure we have the team members full job title. In this case, John is joining as a People Group Fullstack Engineer, which would follow the naming convention from above, and end up being named: `rolepeoplegroupfullstackengineer.md`.

Now any one in the in the People Operations department that is onboarding for the People Group Fullstack Engineer role will include this template in the onboarding issue.

Now finally we have successfully created country, entity, division, department, and role specific tasks for the new team member. ·

SECTION: people-group/engineering/miscellaneous.md

Team page entry daily sync

Once/day we run a pipeline that syncs the following fields for all team members:

- name, team members preferred name or nick name.
 - Will not sync name from Workday if opted in. This can be changed at any time in the YAML entry itself, to set a custom nickname or preferred name for the team page.
 - Only overwritten if opted out of syncs, in which we will replace with the team members

current job title.

- specialty, included if the team member has a job specialty component.
- departments, A list of the team members Workday department and extra departments added to their team page entry.
 - We will only ever update the first entry of this list to their current Workday department.
- division, person's current division in Workday.
- jobtitle, person's current job title.
- reportsto, the slug reference of the team members manager team page entry.
- gitlab the customGitLabUsername value from Workday.
- public whether or not the team member has selected having their information exported or not.

This means that if team members edit that field in the file, this will result in the sync overwriting when it runs again. The reason for this is that we consider Workday as the single source of truth for this data. Thus team members and managers will need to make adjustments in Workday first and this will be automatically propagated in the team page entry.

Team members can edit their export preferences at any time by following this job aid, which will reflect their export preferences the next time the sync runs.

Diagram

```
<div style="width: 640px; height: 480px; margin: 10px; position: relative;"><iframe
allowfullscreen frameborder="0" style="width:640px; height:480px"
src="https://lucid.app/documents/embedded/236d061a-50b5-4917-a74d-29715ed035e1"
id="ZwPRKLUTflmI"></iframe></div>
```

Caveats

- In the event that a daily sync is not merged the same day, that is fine, we can close the outdated MR and merge the most recent as this will contain the latest changes only updating files currently included in the handbook.
- Pipelines may fail when adding to the merge train if a team member edited their team page entry after the MR was opened, most can be resolved by using the /rebase quick action, or by resolving conflicts manually. As above, these will usually resolve themselves on the next sync.

Sensitive data compliant Time Off by Deel export

Every week, a scheduled job queries all PTO events occurring during a ± 4 week time frame. Sensitive information (eg. the type of PTO taken) is then filtered out from these PTO events. The compliant data is then uploaded to a Google Cloud Storage bucket for the data analytics team to consume.

The data team then makes a subset of this information available via Sisense to allow team members to create more accurate charts for metrics like number of merge requests per team member over a 30-day period.

Netherlands accrual adjustments

A scheduled job runs on January first and for each team member located in the Netherlands, if their Employee Accruals balance is negative, it is set back to 0 days.

A similar scheduled job also runs on July first, but in this case, for each team member located in the Netherlands, if their Employee Accruals balance exceeds 10 days, it is set back to 10 days.

Set closed training issues to confidential

Once per day, closed issues in the training project are automatically marked as confidential for compliance.

Letter of employment

Every hour, a scheduled job checks the letter of employment requests spreadsheet for new entries. For each entry, a letter of employment will be generated using the team member's Workday data. The letter is then sent directly to the team member's work email address.

To retrieve your letter of employment, please use the process in the internal handbook [here](#).

Entities sync

Once per week, Workday locations are synced to GitLab groups. Team members are then added to the correct group. The list of groups (entities) can be found in the entities project.

When creating a merge request or issue that affects all members of a given GitLab entity, all members with direct membership can be pinged using `@gitlab-com/entities/<entity-name>`.

eg. for Canada Corp, use `@gitlab-com/entities/canada-corp`.

On-call scheduling spreadsheet

On the first day of each month, we populate a spreadsheet including information for team members who have been at GitLab for more than 3 months. The spreadsheet is used by engineering to plan for on-call availability.

Synced fields are sourced from Workday.

- Name
- Job title
- Start Date
- Division
- Department
- Role
- Weekend availability
- Email
- Manager

GitLab Group

We utilize a GitLab.com group for internal communications ('pings') on GitLab.com. This helps ensure the appropriate team members from the team are alerted and reduces noise for others that may not need to be alerted.

This group is public <https://gitlab.com/gl-people-engineering>, and can be mentioned by tagging @gl-people-engineering within an issue, merge request, or epic on GitLab.com.

> Project creation for this group has been disabled, all People Group Engineering projects that can be public should be committed to <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/people-group-public/engineering>.

Access Request issue closing

Access Requests open for longer than 30 days will be closed automatically by the Employment Bot.

We run this job once a week to check for any open issues older than 30 days, except for ones with the AccessReview label, and leave the following note closing the issue:

text

This access request issue has been open for more than 30 days. It is being automatically closed to de-clutter this issue tracker.

If there are any tasks remaining or this was not supposed to be closed, reopen the issue and ping the DRIs to get them completed as soon as possible.

/close

SECTION: people-group/engineering/nominatorbot.md

We're using a custom Slack app, the Nominator Bot, that team members can use to nominate other team members for discretionary bonuses.

To nominate someone you type in /nominate. The bot will open a dialog with additional details to fill in. Once filled in, you can submit the nomination. This nomination will be stored in a database and sent through Slack to the nominee's manager.

> The manager can then decide to approve or reject this nomination.

On approval, the bot will send this nomination to the second level manager, and if approved, to the People Connect Team for final approval. On the final approval, it is added to Workday as a one time bonus payment. The nominator AND the manager of the nominee are also updated about a final approval. The manager will receive a message with the full nomination and will be asked to share this with the nominee and to share it in the thanks channel on Slack.

On rejection, an additional modal will pop-up asking for the rejection reason. This reason is only to be used in an aggregated way to get details about why nominations are rejected. This is not shared with anyone else or shown in the Home views. The nominator will see that the nomination was rejected but they won't see why. The bot will send a message to the person who rejected asking to share feedback with the nominator.

Features

Update a nomination

Since 2021-03-05 all approvers also have the option to update a nomination. Sometimes the nomination although valid, doesn't contain enough information. By clicking the update button the approver can edit the nomination message. Once updated, it can be approved (or rejected) and it will be sent to the next approver with the updated message.

Retrigger the approver

Sometimes a nomination is "stuck" with an approver. A nominator can use the home section of the nominatorbot to let the bot send a new message to the person who needs to approve. We only allow a retrigger when:

- the nomination has not been approved or rejected yet
- AND the nomination was either created more than 24 hours ago or the last review has happened more than 24 hours ago
- AND in case a retrigger was already sent out, it also needs to be more than 24 hours ago

Please be mindful using this retrigger functionality. There could be a valid reason why the approver is taking a few days to approve or reject the nomination.

Follow the state of a nomination as a manager

When you've approved a nomination and you want to be able to follow up the nomination. In the home section of the nominator bot, there is a button Reviewed Nominations. Upon clicking that button a list will be loaded with all the nominations you've reviewed and their current status.

Frequently asked questions

How can I nominate someone?

Anywhere in Slack, just type /nominate and a modal should open where you can submit the form. Alternatively, you can go to the Home tab of the Nominator and click the Nominate! button. This will do the same as when you just type /nominate.

I don't seem to be able to submit my nomination?

Sometimes people report that Slack does not allow them to submit the nomination. Please make sure to check you've filled in all the fields. It's not always clear you need to scroll down to fill in the How does this meet the criteria? question as well.

I nominated someone recently and I still haven't heard back?

The first step you should do is have a look at the Nominator's Home section in Slack. There you will see a list of all the nominations you've made and what the status is. For every nomination we show:

- the nominee
- the status
- values
- the message

The status is what you can use to see where the nomination might be stuck. Different options:

- Waiting for manager approval: this means that the manager of the nominee has not approved it yet.
- Waiting for second level approval: this means that the manager of the manager of the nominee has not approved it yet.
- Waiting for People Group approval: this means that someone from the People Group team still need to approve it

There are also the following statuses, although at this point the nomination approval flow is wrapped up:

- Rejected: sadly the nomination was rejected. The bot doesn't reach out when this happens, as we ask the rejector to reach out
- Approved: great news, this means the nomination was approved. The bot should've reached out to let you know about this.

Secondly, if the current person who needs to approve has been notified of a nomination more than 24hours ago, you can use the Remind Approver button next to the nomination in this home section. This will ping the current approver by starting a thread on the original message with the following message:

:waves: <@{channel}> Friendly ping not to forget about this nomination.

If all of the above doesn't help you move the process forward, feel free to reach out to someone from People Group Engineering.
We will need the name of the nominee, please only do this in DM.

I approved a nomination but I haven't heard back?

First thing to note is that only the manager of the nominee will hear back when the nomination is fully approved. So if you're the second level approver, you will not get any notifications.

However, every approver will have a section in the Nominator's Home tab on Slack where they can see all the nominations they've approved.

1. In Slack, open the Nominator conversation
1. Click on the Home tab
1. Click on Reviewed nominations

This will load all the nominations you've reviewed, you will be able to see the state that nominations are in. These states are all the same as mentioned in the above I nominated someone recently and I still haven't heard back? question.

I was informed that I had a Nomination pending my approval, but I haven't received any notifications?

Due to limitations in place by Slack, we might not be notified of an approval request if the Nominatorbot App has become hidden from the App list. To prevent missing these notifications it is recommended to star your conversation with the Bot or move to a channel grouping, so it doesn't go missing if you haven't interacted with the Bot for a while.

We can move this by following these steps:

1. Right click on your conversation with the Nominator bot.
1. Select Move Conversation from the menu.
1. Select Starred or another channel grouping.

To check up on any requests awaiting your approval we can also follow these steps:

1. In Slack, open the Nominator conversation.
1. Click on the Messages tab.

Actions performed by engineers

Offboarding

When a people manager offboards, it could be that the person still had pending nominations. To make sure these don't get stuck, we are pinged in the offboarding issue and we have to run the following snippet on the production shell:

```
text
/cnb/lifecycle/launcher bundle exec rake offboarding:run[EMPLOYEEENUMBER]
```

This will do a lookup on nominations that are pending for a manager or second level manager approver and will resend the nomination approval to the new manager.

To take into account:

- you can only perform this if the reports have been assigned new managers
- if you're uncomfortable running an executing script, you can first to the dry run version: `/cnb/lifecycle/launcher bundle exec rake offboarding:dryrun[EMPLOYEEENUMBER]`. This will print out the nominations that we would retrigger.

Don't forget to check off the task on the offboarding issue so the People Connect team knows it's been done.

Requests and or bugs

Upcoming iterations can be found [here](#)

Issues with the bot and/or feedback about the process can be created [here](#). We welcome contributions to the project!

SECTION: people-group/engineering/offboarding.md

The People Group Engineering team aims to reduce as much manual work as possible. One of the areas we have done this, is everything related to the employment automation flow.

Offboarding

Note: this section only discusses items in the offboarding where People Engineering was involved. You can read more about offboarding at GitLab on this [handbook page](#)

Timeline Flow

mermaid

graph TD

A[Offboarding is approved in Workday] --> |All offboardings on last day of Work| B

A --> |When the offboarding is voluntary| G

B[Offboarding issue is created, manager is assigned] --> C

C[Offboarding merge request is created] --> D

D[Team member is removed from gitlab-com and gitlab-org] --> G

G[Informational email is sent to the departing team member] --> |2 days before departure| H

H[Slack message is sent to the departing team member]

> Terminations will be processed within a valid offboarding window for the day, according to the team members current timezone of their primary address in Workday. Please see, the [Scheduled Offboarding Issue Creation](#) section for more.

Automations

Voluntary offboarding email

When a team member voluntarily leaves GitLab, an email going over the offboarding interview and frequently asked questions is automatically sent to them.

The pipeline is scheduled to run every hour and scan for any recent voluntary offboardings that have been submitted in Workday. Email status is then synced to our notification spreadsheet to ensure these emails are not sent out again.

Scheduled offboarding issue creation

Every 15 minutes, a pipeline scans Workday for any terminations.

All scheduled offboardings will be opened between 4:00 - 5:00pm of the team members local timezone.

For each row matching this criterion, it will perform the same actions as if a People Connect Team member ran manually initiated the offboarding. (see Manually initiated offboarding issue creation and Offboarding merge request sections).

The manual process is kept as a backup process should the automation fail or for exceptional cases where a team member offboarding cannot be added to the offboarding spreadsheet.

After the offboarding issue has been created, we send a follow up message to the offboardings Slack channel containing the team members name, last day of work, and a link to the opened offboarding issue.

<details>

<summary>Automation Overview</summary>

<div style="width: 640px; height: 480px; margin: 10px; position: relative;"><iframe allowfullscreen frameborder="0" style="width:640px; height:480px" src="https://lucid.app/documents/embedded/982e697f-797d-426e-ac2a-6065b8422460" id="t~UzrcpTElj"></iframe></div>

</details>

Manually initiated offboarding issue creation

After a People Connect Team member runs the Slack command to open the issue, this will be automatically assigned to the People Connect Team member who ran the command and the outgoing team member's Manager.

The job then grabs various details of the outgoing team member, like country of residence, entity through which they are hired, division, department, job title etc. For each of these details, it checks for the existence of a task file in the offboardingtasks folder of the employment project. These tasks files are of the format country<country name>.md, entity<entity name>.md, division<division name>.md, department<department name>.md, etc. If such a file is found, it includes contents of those files also in the offboarding issue.

This issue is added to the team member's epic.

Offboarding merge request

The offboarding command will also create a merge request to the www-gitlab-com project. This MR includes:

- Removing the individual file from the data/teammembers/person directory
- Removing the picture used in the previous file
- Adjusting the reports to in case the offboarded team member had reports
- Removing the pet picture in case the team member had any
- Update the CODEOWNERS file: change to the manager or remove if the manager is already a codeowner for that file

In the event that the merge request has become out of date and the /rebase quick action isn't

working a People Connect Team member can follow these steps to regenerate the MR:

1. Close the MR that is out of date, and ensure to delete the branch that this was created on.
1. Run the offboarding team page Slack command to re-trigger the automation.
1. Verify that the MR has been opened.

90 Day Offboarding Issue Closer

Every day, Monday-Friday, we run an automation to check for offboarding issues that have been open longer than 90 days. If any are found, we leave a comment with the /close quick action to close the issue.

Reasoning

This aims to cleanup the employment project of any offboarding issues that have already been completed, as these issues are subject to a 5 day SLA from when the issue is created, there should be no remaining tasks by the 90 day mark.

More information regarding this addition in this issue.

Details

We leverage the issues API to search for related issues matching the following filters:

ruby

```
{
  createdbefore: "{90.days.ago.endofday.iso8601}", eg. 2019-03-15T08:00:00
  perpage: 100, limit results to 100 issues per request
  labels: [ 'offboarding' ], only match issues with the 'offboarding' label
  state: 'opened', only match open issues
  confidential: true, all offboardings are confidential by default
}
```

We then iterate through the collection of issues to leave comments closing each issue out with the following message:

text

This issue has been opened for more than 90 days and is going to be automatically closed.
If you have any remaining items on this issue complete them immediately.

/close

SECTION: people-group/engineering/onboarding.md

The People Group Engineering team aims to reduce as much manual work as possible. One of the areas we have done this, is everything related to the employment automation flow.

Everything on this page, assumes the team member is already present in Workday.

Onboarding

Note: this section only discusses items in the onboarding where People Engineering was involved.

Timeline Flow

mermaid

graph TD

A[2 Weeks before: People Connect triggers Slack command for onboarding issue] -->|Onboarding issue is created, manager is assigned| K

K[1 day before: Team member is invited to gitlab-com and gitlab-org] --> I

I[Start date: onboarding and swag email is send to the team member] --> C

C[Day 2: Access Request issue is created and team page sync readiness is checked.] --> CA

CA[Day 3: Team page entry is created] --> E

E[Day 6: Team members receive a Slack reminder about the anti-harrassment training] --> J

J[Day 7: Manager and Interview training issues are opened if people manager] --> L

L[Day 15: Team member is pinged if they have open compliance task on their onboarding issue] --> F

F[Day 60: Onboarding issue is closed if it wasn't closed already] --> N{Probation?}

N -->|Yes| D[One month before contract end: send email]

N -->|No| B{Netherlands team member}

B -->|Yes| G[Two month before: Send email]

Onboarding issue creation

The onboarding issue creation is a semi-automated process. Meaning that it needs to be triggered by a People Connect team member to be started. A People Connect team member can make use of the onboarding Slack command to initiate the process.

The onboarding issue will be automatically assigned to the People Connect Team member who ran the command and the incoming team member's Manager.

The onboarding tasks that are applicable to all team members are listed in the general onboarding.md file. It will be included by default in the onboarding issue.

The job then grabs various details of the incoming team member, like country of residence, entity through which they are hired, division, department, job title etc. For each of these details, it checks for the existence of a task file in the onboardingtasks folder of the employment project. These tasks files are of the format country<country name>.md, entity<entity name>.md, division<division name>.md, department<department name>.md, role<exact job title>.md, etc. If such a file is found, it includes contents of those files also in the onboarding issue.

Role templates don't take seniority into level. For example SDR 1, 2, or 3 would all receive the SDR template.

If you receive a question from a manager about why a template was not linked in an onboarding

issue, be sure to check the naming convention of the template and ensure everything matches up in Workday with the entity, division, department, etc. If everything looks like it's matched up, reach out to the People Group Engineer for additional assistance.

Note: If a People Connect Team member needs to create the onboarding issue for interns, they can use the same Slack command.

This issue is added to the team member's epic.

If you want to read more about how employment issues are set up, please read this section.

Invited to GitLab.com

We run a scheduled pipeline every day that invites team members starting the following day to the two main GitLab groups:

- gitlab-com
- gitlab-org

The invite email is sent to their GitLab email address which they will get access to the next day.

> These invites are set to expire one month after their start date.

Onboarding Email

This is the email that is sent to our team members on the morning of their first day of employment (based upon the onboarding date in the issue title). The email is cc'd to people-connect@domain.

Every day we run 3 scheduled pipelines. They are each set up for a specific region:

- Americas at 10 AM UTC
- EMEA at 4 AM UTC
- APJ at 6 PM UTC

For the APJ pipeline, it will fetch the team members with a start date for the next day (timezones).

For the EMEA and Americas pipelines, it will fetch all the team members that have a start day equal to the current day (so who is starting today). The pipeline then filters out the ones for the region they need to send the email to. This all is to ensure we don't send out the email too late or too early.

The region of the team member is determined from the region that is on their Workday profile. This is the first iteration, if we need to split it up by country, we can rework the current implementation.

We fetch some other data besides the region as well:

- their onboarding issue URL
- their name

This data is used to populate the email that we then send to them. The email address used to send the email is onboarding@domain and is set with a reply-to: people-connect@domain as nobody monitors replies to onboarding@. The email address is strictly used for automation.

Manual Onboarding E-Mail

If for some reason the e-mail could not be sent, we have added functionality for a People Connect Team member to be able to manually send this by running the onboardingemail Slack command.

This triggers the following flow:

mermaid
graph TD

```
A[PEA triggers the automation via Slack] --> B(Finds the open onboarding issue)
B --> C(Finds the Workday profile from the onboarding issue description)
C --> D(Sends the e-mail to the team member)
```

Updating Email Template

If changes are required to the onboarding email template, follow these steps to update them:

- Browse to the MJML page
- Open the MJML template
- Copy and paste the template file of your choice into MJML website on the left
- Make the relevant changes and then select View HTML on the top left hand side of the website.
- Copy the HTML version to the HTML template.
- Copy and pasted the MJML version from the browser to the MJML template.
- Submit Merge Request like normal with the updates.

Swag Email

This is the email that is sent on the first day of a new team member so they receive the instructions to redeem their new hire swag. The email is cc'd to people-connect@domain.

Every day at 9 AM UTC we run a scheduled pipeline. This pipeline will fetch all the eligible team members. An eligible team member means:

- Team member who is on their first day of employment at GitLab

The email address used to send the email is onboarding@domain and is set with a reply-to: people-connect@domain as nobody monitors replies to onboarding@domain. The email address is strictly used for automation.

Access Request issue creation

To get access to the tools our team members need for their job, an Access Request (AR) issue needs to be created. To make sure our team members experience a good onboarding, we automated this process by creating the AR Role based entitlement issue with the bot.

Every day we run 3 scheduled pipelines. They are each set up for a specific region:

- Americas at 10 AM UTC
- EMEA at 4 AM UTC
- APJ at 6 PM UTC

For the APJ pipeline, it will fetch the team members with a start date for the current day (timezones).

For the EMEA and Americas pipeline, it will fetch all the team members that have a start day equal

to the previous day (so who started yesterday). The pipeline then filters out the ones for the region

they need to send the email to. This all is to ensure we don't create the issue too late or too early.

The region of the team member is determined from the region that is on their Workday profile.

For all these members it will check if it is possible to create an Access Request issue. It will only work for the members with roles that have a set template in the role baseline access requests tasks directory.

The templates are created on a role level and can be created for the specialty level as well.

For example

if you have a person with the role Security Engineer, Strategic Security. The code will look for two templates:

rolesecurityengineer.md and rolesecurityengineerstrategicsecurity.md. Note: you don't need to have both created,

but if there are two, the code will use both to create the issue, if there is just one, it will create the one it can find.

The issue will be created in the AR project.

The bot will announce in Slack (peopleops-alerts-private) the list of people that we were able to

create the AR. As well as the list of people (with their role) that we weren't

able to create the AR for. This way we can connect with the teams so they can add a template for this role.

For those that we can not create an issue, the Employment bot will leave a comment on the onboarding issue. In this comment the manager is tagged to inform them and we ask them to create the issue and if needed to create a template for future hires.

Note: People Operations is not responsible for creating or maintaining the templates, each team is responsible for creating the templates for their roles. This is also explained in the

README of the project.

Here's a video with the People Group Engineer going over the AR automation. They discuss how it works and how a template can be added.

```
{{< youtube "aPe77q23OE8" >}}
```

Team page readiness check

Every day at 09AM UTC, we have a pipeline running that fetches all the team members that started yesterday and check if they can be synced to the team page. Currently the only required item to determine if we can sync them is that they need to have a GitLab username.

If we can't determine their GitLab username (from the issue or from their Workday profile) we will leave an issue note on the onboarding issue asking them to fill in their Workday profile correctly.

Sync to team page

Every day at 09AM UTC, we have a pipeline running that syncs our new team members to the [www-gitlab-com](https://www.gitlab.com) project, so that they show up on the team page.

> Many teams have adopted the team page entries for building out custom partials within the handbook, any changes to this process should be sent in [whats-happening-at-gitlab](#) prior to get insights from other teams on their particular use cases.

We fetch all the new team members with a start date of the day before yesterday and check if they opted-in on being synced to the team page. Opt-in happens by setting Export Name Location to Team Page to Yes on their Workday profile. This is a task on day one for the new team member.

```
{{% alert title="Note" color="primary" %}}
```

You can find a Howto guide for setting the Opt-in mentioned above by searching for a doc titled, "How to: Set Team Page Export Preferences" in Google drive.

```
{{% /alert %}}
```

If they selected yes, we grab some data (name, job title, start date, department and country) and format it,

so it can be added to the team page entry. If they did not opt-in, we still add an entry to the team page.

However that entry is anonymous. For every new team member, we commit a new file in the `data/teammembers` directory.

We then create a merge request on [www-gitlab-com](https://www.gitlab.com) project so it can be merged.

The merge request is assigned to the People Connect team and they set it to merge when the pipeline succeeds.

Possible Errors and Fixes

In the event we run into errors with the team page sync, we have some backup plans in place.

In case team members did not fill in the required data, we won't be able to sync them. A People Connect Team member can later on sync them by running the `teampageindividual` Slack command.

This will spin up a pipeline and fetch the details. Note that if the team member was synced already, it will abort the sync.

If the entire group of team members was missed, in the event of a failed pipeline or another error, a People Connect Team member can re-run the sync by using the `teampageweek` Slack command.

This will trigger a new pipeline and fetch the new team members of the provided week and create a new merge request adding them to the Team page.

Slack reminder for the anti-harrassment training

We have a daily pipeline that checks everyday who started 6 days ago. For those team members, we send a reminder that they have to complete the anti-harrassment training.

Manager and Interview training issues

There's a scheduled pipeline that runs every day that checks for hires that started a week ago. For those hires we will look if the incoming team member is a people manager. Currently there's no exact field on Workday for us to check this. The way we do this is by looking at their job title. If it starts with any of the following:

- Team Lead
- Manager
- Senior Manager
- Director
- Senior Director
- Chief
- VP
- Vice President

We also consider the person a people manager when the job title ends with:

- Area Sales Manager

We create the Interview Training and Becoming a Manager issues in the People Group Training project.

Onboarding compliance checks

We run a scheduled pipeline every day that fetches our team members that are on their 15th day of employment at GitLab. We look on their onboarding issue if they have any compliance tasks

open.

A compliance task is marked with the :red-circle icon. If they have any open tasks the onboarding bot will tag the user asking to finish the open tasks.

Onboarding issue closing

It is expected that onboarding issues be completed and closed within 30 days of opening. To remind team members about this, we are using the due date functionality in GitLab issues. When an onboarding issue is created, we automatically calculate the due date by adding 31 days to their start date. GitLab will send a reminder notification email to all the assignees of the issue near the due date.

In addition to this due date, team members get an additional 30 days to complete and close the onboarding issue. In total, a team member gets around 60 days to complete their onboarding issue.

We have a scheduled pipeline to close the outdated issues (issues that have been open for more than 60 days). This pipeline will add a comment on the issue that it is being automatically closed and what the team members should do if they have onboarding tasks remaining.

Currently, the pipeline is scheduled to be run at 09:30 PM on every Friday. It will close all the onboarding issues created before 60 days from that date.

SECTION: people-group/engineering/organization-change.md

The People Group Engineering team aims to reduce as much manual work as possible. One of the areas we have done this, is everything related to the employment automation flow.

Organization Change

Note: this section only discusses items in the offboarding where People Engineering was involved. You can read more about promotions and transfers at GitLab on this handbook page

Timeline Flow

mermaid
graph TD

```
A[People Connect triggers Slack command for organization change issue] --> B
B[Organization Change issue is created, team member is assigned] --> C
C[Organization Change issue is automatically marked confidential] --> D
D[Manager and Interview training issues are opened if people manager] --> E
E[Access Request reminder is commented on the issue]
```

Organization Change Checklist issue creation

Once a People Connect Team member runs the organization checklist command through Slack, this triggers a pipeline in the employment project, which will run the job transition, and reply with a link to the newly created organization change issue.

The issue will be automatically assigned to the following people:

- People Connect Team member who ran the command
- the team member
- the previous manager of the team member
- the new manager of the team member
- the People Business Partner for the team member's department or division

This issue is then added to the team member's epic.

Make confidential

Sometimes, issues are created by humans instead of a bot, in this case they can forget to mark the issue as confidential. We run a daily pipeline to mark issues as confidential in the training project. This includes manager and interview training issues as the employment project is internal to GitLab team members anyway.

Manager and Interview training issues

This is the same as the manager and interview training issues we create for onboarding. Except that for onboarding we only create it after day 7 and for organization change we create it at the same time as the organization change issue.

Read here

Baseline Entitlements / Access Request

Once per day we run a job to open any baseline entitlement access requests for the team members new role. This is handled by the daily organization checklists job in the employment automation project. This job can also be ran utilize /pops to run adhoc.

Access request reminders

A job is scheduled to run once per day to look for organization change issues that have been opened for 5 days. If the team member for whom a organization change issue was opened has not been mentioned in any access requests since their organization change issue was opened, an note is created on the organization change issue to remind the participants to create the necessary access requests.

Template Placeholders

Organization Change templates can make use of the following placeholders to be replaced with different tags of content. See the table below.

Placeholder	Description
---	---

NAME	Team members display name
TEAMMEMBERHANDLE	Team members GitLab username
MANAGERHANDLE	New manager GitLab username
MANAGERNAME	New manager display name
PREVIOUSMANAGERHANDLE	Previous manger GitLab username
PEOPLEEXPERIENCEHANDLE	People Connect Specialist GitLab username
NEWROLENAME	Job title of the new role.
PREVIOUSROLENAME	Job title of the previous role.
TRANSITIONDATE	The date of the transition into the new role. Format: YYYY-MM-DD

<details><summary>Example how to use</summary>

mrkdwn

This is my template for NEWROLENAME

MANAGERHANDLE To Do

- [] 123
- [] abc

PREVIOUSMANAGERHANDLE To Do

- [] 123
- [] abc

</details>

SECTION: people-group/engineering/pops-internal-handbook.md

Overview

Some of our processes can not be made public and we can't even share them internally. For those reasons, People Operations has a internal handbook, where only a limited amount of people have access.

The project is hosted outside of the gitlab-com group (for access reasons) and is available here. However, you need to be invited to have access.

Once you have access to the project, you will also have access to the People Operations internal handbook.

Usage

Only to be used for items that we can't share in the internal only or public handbook. This should contain very limit amount of information.

Get access

Create an access request and assign it to the Director, People Operations. They will add you as a member to the project. Once you have access to the project, you will also have access to the hosted page.

Engineer Access Requests

People Group Engineers will need a couple of Access Requests in order to maintain, test, and deploy our current integrations and applications.

Name	Description
Oktapreview	Allows us to log in to okta in your development environment.
Google Cloud Console, pops-tools & Compute Admin	Allows us to manage our kubernetes clusters, this is where our production integrations live.
1Password (People Group Vault)	Gives us access to different API keys and passwords for our integrations.
Sentry Alerts	For monitoring application status and get notifications if there are any errors in production.
ops.gitlab.net	Production repository mirror of projects on gitlab.com, this holds our environment variables and secret keys.
dev.gitlab.net	Our development repository mirrors, similar to above.
ngrok	Allows us to test slack integrations without hitting our production server. This reroutes external requests to our local machine.
Letter of Employment Spreadsheet	Helps us keep track of new hires and double check with existing integrations.
Workday Permission	Enough permission to be able to use the web interface for simple team member look ups and should be able to use the API with the correct level of permission.
Greenhouse Job Admin: People Success permission.	This allows us to use the Greenhouse API within our integrations for testing and debugging.
Slack API	Permission to access Slack's API both for production and developmental purposes.
People Group Engineering GitLab Group Access	Grants us access to our publicly available projects. Nominatorbot, People-Connect, etc.
Compensation Calculator Admin & Repository Access	Allows us to grant or revoke permission to use the compensation calculator. Also lets us view the project on GitLab and make contributions.

SECTION: people-group/engineering/slack-integrations.md

Integrations

For several smaller automations we use integrations with Slack. On this page you can find an overview of all the integrations we've set up. Most of these integrations use a Slack bot named PeopleOps Bot.

Anniversary announcements

A scheduled pipeline is configured to automatically send a message congratulating all team members celebrating a work anniversary that week to the Slack channel team-member-updates. The message will contain list of all such team members and the number of years they are celebrating at GitLab.

Currently, the pipeline is scheduled to be run at 10:00 AM UTC on every Thursday.

Birthday announcements

Every monday morning, a scheduled pipeline is configured to automatically send a message congratulating team members celebrating their birthday that week to the celebrations Slack channel. Only team members who have opted-into GitLab birthdays on their Slack profile will be listed in the congratulatory message.

To opt-in, follow these steps on Slack

1. Click on your profile photo in the top right corner
1. Click on Edit profile
1. Scroll down to the GitLab Birthdays field and select Yes

Informing People Connect Team about details missing in Workday for upcoming new hires

For the new hire announcements to be accurate, it is required to ensure the Workday details of team members joining the following week is as complete as possible. To help the People Connect team in this task, another scheduled pipeline is run to verify if the Workday details of all incoming team members is complete. This pipeline notifies the People Connect Specialists in peopleops-alerts channel about people whose details are missing and the details that are missing for each person.

Since the People Connect Specialists should have enough time to fix these missing details before new hire announcements are sent, it is necessary this job should be run an adequate amount of time before the new hire announcements job is run. Currently, the pipeline is scheduled to be run at 02:00 PM on every Wednesday.

Employment survey

Whenever a team member fills in on of the following surveys, the form entrance is put into a slack message to the private Slack channel employment-survey. This way the People Connect team can discuss and take action.

- Onboarding Survey
- Values Check-In
- Career Mobility Value Check-In
- Career Mobility Satisfactory Survey

GitLab Usernames

Often times, team members won't follow the procedure outlined on the tools and tips page to

change their GitLab username. This leads to inaccurate or outdated data in Workday. To remedy this situation, every Wednesday, we audit all GitLab usernames stored on Workday (GitLab Username field) and verify that those usernames are members of the gitlab-com group. When a Workday GitLab Username is not in the group, a message is automatically sent in peopleops-alerts on Slack.

Pops Commands

We have more documentation regarding available /pops commands in Slack in the internal handbook [here](#).

Template Paths

People Connect associates can type /pops run templatepaths <EMPLOYEENUMBER> to output the list of locations where the bot looks to fill-in role/specialty based access request and onboarding tasks. This command is useful when it is unclear why an automated issue creation did not pick up a given template. This will show exactly what path the bot expects.

SECTION: people-group/engineering/team-pto-calendar.md

As a way of tracking PTO in a shared team calendar, the steps outlined below will walk you through how to configure your Time Off by Deel to automatically sync your OOO events to your teams shared calendar.

Steps

1. Open Google Calendar.

1. Under the My calendars section on the left navigation bar, find the shared calendar with your name.

1. Point to the shared calendar and click More > Settings and sharing.

1. Scroll down to the Integrate Calendar section and copy the Calendar ID.

1. Under Slack -> Time Off by Deel -> Home, click on the dropdown Settings > and select Calendar Sync

1. Click on Add Calendar and add your teams shared Calendar ID.

1. Give yourself a pat on the back as you are now successfully synced to your teams shared calendar!

Template For the Entire Team

To get the entire team on the same calendar it is recommend to create an issue using the following template to ensure each team member can follow the installation steps themselves.

Here is an example markdown template for requesting this addition from your team:

markdown

As a way of tracking our PTO in a shared calendar, the steps outlined below will walk you through how to configure your Time Off by Deel to link to this calendar.

1. Under Slack -> Time Off by Deel -> Home, click on the dropdown under the Create OOO and Chat with Support buttons. Under the Settings heading select Calendar Sync.

1. Click on Add Calendar and add your teams shared Calendar ID CALENDAR ID HERE.

1. tada: Give yourself a pat on the back as you are now successfully synced to your teams shared calendar!

1. When you have completed these tasks, please mark as done below · and unassign yourself.

<!-- List of team members to complete these steps -->

<!-- - [] @teammember -->

<!-- - [] @teammember1 -->

SECTION: people-group/general-onboarding/_index.md

Onboarding is incredibly important at GitLab. We don't expect you to hit the ground running from day one.

We highly recommend taking at least two full weeks for onboarding and only in week three starting with team specific onboarding and training. Please feel free to participate in your team's work in your first two weeks, but don't feel like you have to contribute heavily.

All onboarding steps are in the onboarding issue template which is owned by the People Connect team. The onboarding process for the new team member is self-driven and self-learning, whilst also remaining as asynchronous as possible settling into the remote life at GitLab.

At GitLab we take great pride in dogfooding our own product, that is why all onboarding tasks are completed in a GitLab issue. First of all, what is an issue? You can learn more about what an issue is here.

The People Connect Specialist assigned to the team members specific onboarding will open the onboarding issue at least 4 days prior to the hire date.

Each onboarding issue has a main section that contains tasks relevant to all GitLab team-members and a due date of 30 days. Below the main section are department and role-specific tasks. Some roles and departments have tasks that link to a supplemental issue template or an additional onboarding page. Reach out to your onboarding buddy or other GitLab team members if you need help understanding or completing any of your tasks.

Through onboarding issues, you should gain access to our team member baseline entitlements. On Day 2 of onboarding an Access Request will be generated, if a template has been created for the role. Access requests are owned by the IT team. If you have any access requests related questions, please reach out to it-help in Slack.

In certain instances, the People Connect team may not be able to assist with onboardings due to a national holiday or Family and Friends Day. These specific dates are documented in the People Connect team availability.

TaNewKi Welcome Call

The People Connect team hosts a pre-onboarding call known as the Ta-New-Ki call (a play on the abstract Tanuki i.e. Japanese raccoon dog you will find in our logo). The purpose of this call, which is hosted in Zoom, is to give soon to onboard team members the chance to meet / socialise and to provide an opportunity to ask any lingering questions ahead of their start date. Internally we refer to this as an AMA (Ask Me Anything) call.

Hiring managers and current team members (such as onboarding buddies), are more than welcome to join the call.

This call occurs every two weeks on Thursday at three times to account for timezones.

- 04:00/16:00 PM PT
- 12:00/00:00 AM PT
- 08:30 AM PT

- For current team members: To add the invite to your calendar, review the GitLab Team Meeting Calendar.
- For future team members: You will receive an email with the future dates.

Please note that this call will take a place a week or two before your actual start date.

Agenda

General Topics Covered

- Review the onboarding process on Day 1
- Encourage team members to take their time
- Self Driven and self service
- Questions from the new team members

Sending out the TaNEWki Call Invite

- Invites are sent by the People Connect Specialist in the respective rotation. This email should be sent out at least one week before the call.

1. Open the Ta"NEW"ki Folder located People Experience/Ops Shared Drive>People Experience>Ta"NEW"ki Call

1. Update the google form to include the next two TaNEWki call dates (AMER/APAC, APAC/EMEA and EMEA/AMER times)

1. Use this email template

1. Add the new team members emails to the BCC line and CC the People Connect team.

1. The People Connect team can check who will be attending the call by looking at the Google response sheet.

1. Once new hires have completed the form an auto-response (via Document Studio) will reply with the zoom link and the date selected.

Slack Channel Support for New Team Members

By default, all new team members are added to the below Slack channels from day 1 to ensure that they are able to ask any questions or for assistance in the correct channels upfront:

- newteammembers (go say hi and introduce yourself)
- diversityinclusionandbelonging (connect with other team members to find out more about what we do in Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging)
- ithelp (any IT related support needed, such as issues with laptop, 1Password, Okta, JAMF, etc)
- questions (anything that the Handbook can't help with)
- donut-be-strangers (need some help setting up a coffee chat)
- team-member-updates (new team member, anniversaries, goodbyes)
- thanks (want to acknowledge and thank someone at GitLab, this is the channel)
- whats-happening-at-gitlab (all important updates/reminders/notifications related to GitLab)

Managers of New Team Members

An issue is created for new team members at least 4 business days prior to their start date. The Manager and a People Connect Team member will be assigned to this issue. Managers and People Connect all have tasks that need to be completed prior to the start date to ensure a smooth and successful onboarding process. For questions or help with any of these tasks feel free to reach out in the issue or by creating a request via HelpLab.

*<i class="fas fa-tasks fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i>*Compliance

The Senior People Connect Specialist completes a monthly audit of all open onboarding issues to ensure that the new team member, manager and People Connect team tasks are completed. More importantly, there are certain tasks which need to be completed in line with our company compliance (security, payroll, etc).

If any tasks are still outstanding, the People Connect Specialist will ping the relevant members on the issue requesting action on the items or checking whether the issue can be closed.

It remains the responsibility of the People Connect Specialist to close the issue and remain compliant.

The employment bot will automatically clo